

THE TOOL · 02

02

THE ATHLETE GOALS SESSION.

BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

WHOSE GOAL IS IT?

If the goal belongs to the parent, she'll quit it the first time it gets hard. The only goals that survive pressure are the ones the athlete owns.

OUTCOMES, SIDE BY SIDE

SAME SPORT. DIFFERENT TRAJECTORY.

PARENT SETS THE GOAL.

- Pressure on every game
- Resentment on the drive home
- "Why are you doing this?"
- Quitting by 16

OUTCOME • EXTRINSIC & BRITTLE

ATHLETE SETS THE GOAL.

- She shows up when you stop asking
- Bad games bounce
- Intrinsic motivation
- Longevity in the sport

OUTCOME • OWNED & DURABLE

HOW TO RUN IT

20 MINUTES. THREE PARTS.

01 Set the table

Calm environment. Not in the car. Not right after a game. Bring a journal. Phones face down.

02 Ask the three questions

You ask. She answers. You write down her words — not yours. Don't narrate, don't correct, don't suggest.

03 Close the book

Read the last line out loud together. Don't bring it up again unless she does. Her goal, her pace.



THE SHORT-TERM GOAL

WHAT DO YOU
WANT TO GET OUT
OF THIS SEASON?

Not what the coach wants. Not what the team wants. Not what you want. Her. Write her answer in her words.

2

THE WHY

WHY DOES PLAYING
THIS SPORT MATTER
TO YOU?

This becomes her anchor on the hard days. Identity. Belonging. Thrill. Escape. There's no wrong answer.
Don't rush her.

3

THE LONG-TERM GOAL

WHAT DOES **SUCCESS** LOOK
LIKE THIS SEASON — THAT
HAS NOTHING TO DO WITH
WINNING?

THE MOMENT YOU
REMININD HER OF HER
GOAL — IT BECOMES
YOUR GOAL .

PRINTABLE WORKSHEET • IN YOUR LIBRARY

THE CONVERSATION ON ONE PAGE.

Three sections. Lined writing area. One closing line
you read out loud together. Print it, run it, keep it.

COURTSIDE DOWNLOAD US LETTER • PDF

MY SHORT-TERM GOAL

MY LONG-TERM GOAL

MY WHY

"This goal belongs to the athlete. Not the parent."

